

Safeguarding Statement

How a platform whose users are mostly children handles child-protection.

Full policy at theenglishhub.app/safeguarding

DESIGNATED SAFEGUARDING LEAD

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We aim to acknowledge any safeguarding concern within **24 hours**.

The English Hub currently operates a single-DSL model. The DSL is a separately-appointed role, distinct from the Data Protection Officer (Calum Johnson).

Our safeguarding posture

- The platform is designed for learners aged 11 and over; the majority of users are under 18.
- Safeguarding-relevant disclosures appearing in essay free-text are routed to the DSL for review within 24 hours.
- We do not operate open messaging between users; there is no student-to-student social channel that could be misused.
- Under-18 accounts are excluded from review invitations and affiliate sign-up, and cannot enter payment details.

- High-privacy defaults (Children's Code Standard 8) are enforced in code — no public leaderboards, no behavioural nudges, no geolocation.

Reporting routes

Anyone — a student, parent, teacher, or member of the public — can raise a safeguarding concern through the report form at theenglishhub.app/safeguarding/report, by email to safeguarding@theenglishhub.app, or by phone to the DSL. We acknowledge within 24 hours.

Emergency signposting (published on the platform)

- **Immediate danger:** 999 (UK) / 999 (Qatar)
- **Childline (UK):** 0800 1111
- **NSPCC (UK):** 0808 800 5000
- **CEOP** for online abuse reporting
- **Qatar:** 919 (child & family protection line)

Reference frameworks

Our safeguarding approach is informed by Keeping Children Safe in Education, Working Together to Safeguard Children, the Children Act 2004, the Online Safety Act 2023, and — for data — UK GDPR, the Data Protection Act 2018, and the ICO Children's Code. We are a technology provider, not a school; where a concern relates to a school's own pupils, we cooperate with the school's designated safeguarding arrangements and the relevant statutory bodies.

Background checks (honest scope)

Roles with access to children's data are subject to identity, right-to-work and reference checks, and to enhanced DBS checks where required by the role. We state this at the level it is actually operated rather than over-claiming blanket vetting.

Whistleblowing

Concerns about how a safeguarding or data-protection matter has been handled can be escalated to the founder and, externally, to the NSPCC whistleblowing line (0800 028 0285) and the ICO. We do not retaliate against anyone who raises a concern in good faith.

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